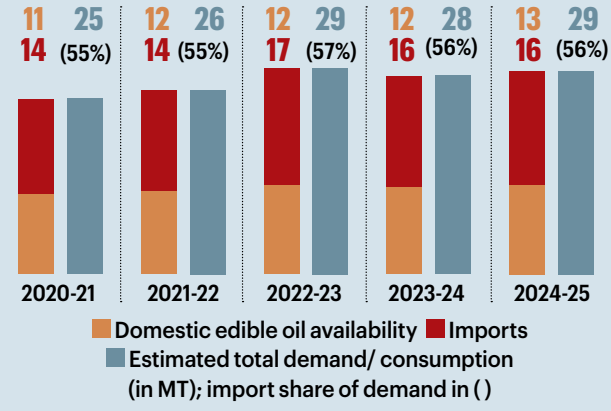


PRODUCTION VS IMPORTS

THE BIG GAP

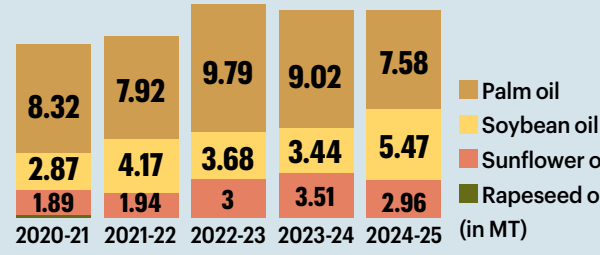
More than half of India's edible oil consumption is imported



IMPORT BASKET

CHANGING MIX

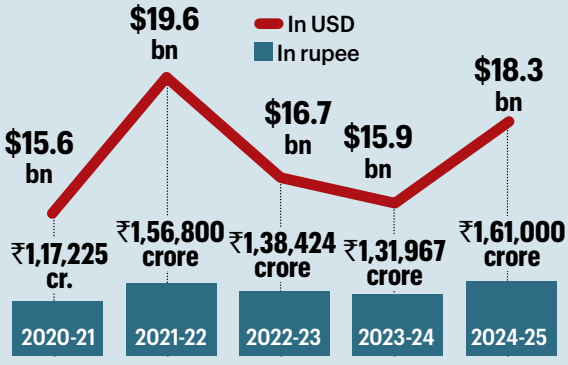
Soybean oil narrows palm oil's long-held lead in imports



IMPORT BILL

RISING TAB

Heavy import of edible oils continues to weigh on India's forex outgo



$ values are annual average exchange rates of respective years

56 PER CENT OF INDIA'S EDIBLE OIL DEMAND OF 28.5 MT IS MET THROUGH IMPORTS

Sources: *GoI, Solvent Extractors' Association of India, Oil Years (Nov. 1-Oct. 31)*

is for wheat and rice, with assured procurement of tur, urad and masoor.

Third, India must expand pulse acreage intelligently, not by pitting dal against foodgrain. Wheat and rice cannot be wished away, but pulses can be grown in the spaces the current system wastes. A return to the traditional practice of intercropping pulses—say, between rows of sugarcane and cotton in Uttar Pradesh and Maharashtra—could unlock an additional 3 million hectares, potentially yielding 2.4 MT of pulses. This is the kind of crop planning India needs—local, flexible and suited to agro-climatic realities, not a one-size-fits-all national template.

Edible Oil, Inedible Truth

As for edible oilseeds, a coverage of 30.5 million hectares gets us just over 43 MT of mustard, groundnut, soybean et al. When crushed, that yields about 13 MT of edible oil. India's total demand? A massive 29 MT, and rising. That's a staggering 56 per cent external dependency, making for India's sixth costliest import ticket. Why